



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

duḥkha+arṇavād vyādhi+vikīrṇa+phenāj* |
jarā+taraṅgān* maraṇa+ugra+vegāt |
uttārayiṣyaty* ayam uhyamānam |
(ārtam* Cārttam*) jagaj* jñāna+mahā+plavena || 1.70 |
prajñā+ambu+vegām* sthira+śīla+vaprām* |
samādhi+śītām* vrata+cakra+vākām |
asya*uttamām* dharma+nadīm pravṛttām |
trṣṇā+ārditaḥ pāsyati jīva+lokaḥ || 1.71 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 1, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Buddhacarita paint a vivid picture of Siddhartha's future role as a savior, a beacon of hope for a world drowning in suffering. Imagine a vast ocean of sorrow (duhkha-arnavad), its surface churned by the foam of disease (vyadhi-vikirna-phenaj), and turbulent with the waves of old age (jara-tarangan). This ocean represents the relentless cycle of birth, aging, sickness, and death, a cycle that sweeps humanity along with its fierce current (marana-ugra-vegat). Siddhartha, the future Buddha, is prophesized to deliver (uttarayisyaty) this world (jagat) from this overwhelming suffering using the great raft of wisdom (jnana-maha-plavena). He is the one who will rescue beings from this turbulent sea.

The verses then introduce a metaphor of a great river, the Dharma (dharma-nadim). This is no ordinary river, but one defined by wisdom (prajna-ambu-vegam), with banks of unwavering morality (sthira-sila-vapram) and cooled by the waters of meditative concentration (samadhi-sitam). The "vows" (vrata-cakra-vakam) are like the birds that gather and sing on the river, representing the beautiful qualities that flourish along its banks. This Dharma river is the path to liberation, and the world, parched by thirst (trsna-arditah), will drink deeply (pasyati) from it, finding solace and quenching their desires.

This ancient wisdom speaks profoundly to your life today. You too can feel tossed about in the ocean of suffering, overwhelmed by the challenges and uncertainties that life throws your way. You may feel thirsty, constantly seeking fulfillment in fleeting pleasures that never truly satisfy. The Buddhacarita reminds you that there is a way out, a path to lasting peace. By cultivating wisdom, practicing ethical conduct, and deepening your meditation, you can navigate the ocean of suffering with greater skill and find true nourishment in the Dharma. Just as the world craves the Dharma river, your own soul yearns for the same liberation.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small step can you take today to cultivate wisdom, morality, or meditation, bringing you closer to the Dharma river within?